

HR Policy for Transformation of Primary Agricultural Credit Societies post Computerisation

PACS / LAMPS / FSS

“Sahakar se Samriddhi” — Prosperity through Cooperation

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1. Introduction

1.1 Purpose of the HR Policy

The purpose of the Model HR Policy is to align with the Ministry of Cooperation's vision of "Sahakar se Samridhhi", aiming to bring uniformity, transparency, and professionalism in HR management across Primary Agricultural Credit Societies (PACS) / Large Area Multipurpose Society (LAMPS) / Farmers Service Society (FSS).

1.2 Objective of HR Policy

The objective of the HR Policy is to:

- Establish uniform staffing norms and recruitment systems aligned with PACS/LAMPS/FSS size and business potential.
- Ensure merit-based hiring and continuous capacity building for diversified service delivery.
- Promote professional ethics, regulatory compliance, and cooperative values across all levels.
- Implement structured appraisals and incentive mechanisms to reward performance and innovation.
- Develop a digitally competent, compliance-oriented workforce integrated with national cooperative platforms.
- Enhance employee dignity, welfare, and career progression through clear roles and service conditions.
- Encourage inclusive, transparent, and accountable workplace practices to boost motivation and retention.
- Overall, provide a strategic framework to address ad-hoc staffing, skill deficits, and low accountability, ensuring efficiency, good governance, and long-term sustainability of PACS and LAMPS.
- Ensure that qualification, selection, and performance norms for PACS HR are non-negotiable and uniformly upheld across all States/UTs, with no compromise on merit-based standards.
- Formulate the policy in active consultation with PACS Employee Federations and States/UTs, ensuring grassroots legitimacy and ownership of the HR framework.
- Cater to the special needs of Northeastern States covered under the 5th and 6th Schedules of the Indian Constitution, with appropriate flexibility in implementation while maintaining core policy standards.

2. Categorization of PACS/LAMPS/FSS

2.1 Criteria for Categorization

To help apply the Model HR Policy in a standardized and practical way, PACS/LAMPS/FSS are classified into categories A+ to F based on audited business levels from the previous financial year. These levels include loans, deposits, mini-bank turnover, and other non-credit activities.

Table 1: Standardised Designations across the PACS

Sr. No.	Standardised Designation
1	Secretary

Sr. No.	Standardised Designation
2	Manager
3	Accountant
4	Assistant Executive (AE)
5	Specialist Officer
6	Clerk
7	Data Entry Operator (DEO)
8	Peon

This classification allows flexible and scalable staffing aligned with each PACS/LAMPS/FSS's size and growth. A categorization matrix defines the suggested staff strength and roles for each category.

Table 2: Categorization Matrix for PACS/LAMPS/FSS Staffing Norms

Sr.	Business Level	Cat.	Min. Staff	Staff Composition
1	Above ₹10 crore	A+	7	Secretary-1, Manager-1, Accountant/AE-1, Specialist-2, Clerk/DEO-2
2	₹5-10 crore	A	6	Secretary-1, Manager-1, Accountant/AE-1, Specialist-1, Clerk/DEO-2
3	₹3-5 crore	B	5	Secretary-1, Manager/Accountant/AE-1, Specialist-1, Clerk/DEO-2
4	₹1-3 crore	C	4	Secretary-1, Manager/Accountant/AE-1, Specialist/Clerk/DEO-2
5	₹50 lakh-1 crore	D	3	Secretary-1, Manager/Accountant/AE/Specialist-1, Clerk/DEO-1
6	₹25-50 lakh	E	2	Secretary-1, Specialist/Clerk/DEO-1
7	Up to ₹25 lakh	F	2	Secretary-1, Specialist/Clerk/DEO-1

*Note: * Total business size of PACS is average of last 3 years total credit + non-credit business. @ PACS with business level up to ₹25 lakh can have a shared Secretary subject to conditions in para 5.5.2. Minimum staff cannot be less than 2 (maker-checker principle).*

2.2 Guiding Principles for Incremental Staffing as per Business Level

Incremental staffing may be adopted when business level exceeds thresholds, based on actual or projected business growth. Incremental staffing must be supported by a clear financial roadmap ensuring that within 3 years, salaries and administrative costs are met by PACS/LAMPS/FSS revenues.

Table 3: Provision for Incremental Staffing

Sr.	Category	Provision for Incremental Staff as per Business Growth
1-3	A+, A, B	+1 Clerk/DEO per ₹25 lakh increase in business level +1 Specialist per ₹50 lakh increase in business level from specialized activity +1 Manager/Accountant/AE per ₹1 crore business size
4-6	C, D, E	+1 Clerk/DEO per ₹25 lakh increase in credit/non-credit business +1 Specialist per ₹30 lakh increase in business from specialised activity
7	F	Staff augmentation only post upgrade to Category E

2.3 Approval Mechanism for Staffing Beyond Minimum Norms

Table 4: Provision for Staffing Beyond Minimum Norms

Sr.	Conditions	Approving Authority	Remarks
1	Addition in no. of staff due to actual or projected business growth	DLPC on recommendation of PACS Board	Verified through BDP Module of ePACS software
2	Non-credit diversification (e.g. CSC, Retail Outlet)	DLPC	HR Plan including role, scope and cost implications submitted to DLPC
3	Creation of new managerial post	DLPC	Requires justification by PACS to DLPC on hiring for new managerial post
4	Temporary/project-based hiring as defined in Section 14.1	Secretary with Board Resolution	Limited to project duration or capped period, per Section 14.1

Note: Hiring of regular staff will be done as per process mentioned at Section 6, after the requirement has been submitted by PACS to DLPC. PACS can hire temporary/project-based staff as and when required.

3. Implementation and Monitoring — DLPC and SLPC

3-tier States will have DLPC at district level and SLPC at State level, while 2-tier States/UTs will have SLPC at State which will also perform the responsibilities of DLPC.

3.1 District Level PACS Committee (DLPC) – HR

To implement the HR Policy across diverse PACS/LAMPS/FSS, structured mechanisms are needed at district and state levels. The DLPC shall act as the administrative body to ensure implementation of HR policy and address HR and business development related challenges.

DLPC support in staffing, recruitment, training, and financial assistance will be based on local needs. In the case of a 2-tier structure, the SLPC will carry the responsibilities of DLPC.

3.1.1 Composition of DLPC

- Chairperson: President/Chairman, DCCB

- Member: District Cooperative Officer
- Member Secretary: CEO of DCCB
- Subject Matter Expert: District Development Manager, NABARD
- Special Invitees: Secretary/Presidents of two PACS/LAMPS/FSS on rotation basis for every 1 year

3.1.2 Key Roles of DLPC

- HR Policy Monitoring: Ensure district-wide implementation of the HR Policy.
- Staffing and Recruitment: Assess PACS/LAMPS/FSS staff requirements, seek SLPC approval, and manage recruitment, selection, and deployment.
- Business Development Plans (BDPs): Vet and approve BDPs, monitor implementation quarterly.
- Financial Support: Identify financially weak PACS/LAMPS/FSS and administer DLPAF assistance.
- Record Keeping: Oversee the maintenance and authentication of Service Registers, Performance Appraisals, and terminal benefit accounts.
- Disciplinary & Transfers: Act as the appellate authority for disciplinary matters and manage transfers.
- Training Needs Analysis (TNA): Conduct TNA and keep records of training outcomes.
- Audit and Compliance: Monitor timely completion of audits, NPA levels, and compliance with guidelines.
- Data Collection & Reporting: Gather and review PACS/LAMPS/FSS data and submit to SLPC.
- SLPC Directives: Monitor compliance with SLPC guidance.
- Penalty Imposition: Enforce penalties for non-compliance with HR Policy.

3.2 State Level PACS Committee (SLPC) – HR

The SLPC acts as the apex body for HR policy implementation and governance. It provides strategic guidance, enforces policies, and coordinates across institutions. It monitors district-level data, evaluates DLPC performance, and manages state-wide training programs. SLPC ensures fair allocation of assistance funds. SLPC meetings may preferably be held quarterly at the Head Office of the DCCB.

In the case of a 2-tier structure, SLPC will have all the responsibilities of DLPC as well.

3.2.1 Composition of SLPC

- Chairperson: President, StCB
- Member: Registrar of Cooperative Societies / Nominee of RCS
- Member: Chief General Manager (CGM)/Oic of NABARD RO or Nominee of CGM/Oic
- Member Secretary: Managing Director (MD), StCB
- Special Invitees: Presidents of two DCCBs on rotation basis for every 1 year

3.2.2 Functions and Responsibilities of SLPC

- HR Policy Supervision: Ensure statewide adherence to the PACS/LAMPS/FSS HR Policy.

- **Vacancy Review:** Approve DLPC-submitted vacancy assessments and approval for recruitment.
- **Training Coordination:** Review PACS/LAMPS/FSS training needs and coordinate with training institutions.
- **Standards Compliance:** Ensure uniformity in Service Registers, Performance Appraisals, and probation reports.
- **Performance Monitoring:** Periodic review of performance of PACS/LAMPS/FSS against Business Development Plans.
- **MIS and Review:** Develop MIS frameworks and reporting formats.
- **Legal Reforms:** Recommend amendments to relevant cooperative laws and rules to the Government.
- **Pension Scheme Supervision:** Administer a self-financed pension plan for PACS/LAMPS/FSS employees.
- **DLPC Evaluation:** Conduct periodic performance reviews of DLPCs (not applicable in 2-tier structure).
- **Data Analysis & Guidance:** Analyse data submitted by DLPCs and issue performance advisories.

4. Support Funds and Financial Assistance

4.1 District Level PACS Assistance Fund (DLPAF)

The DLPAF shall support PACS/LAMPS/FSS under financial stress or facing consistent losses, ensuring weak but potentially viable societies are not left out of reforms due to lack of resources. Support to be provided through a need-based and tapering financial model, helping PACS implement Business Development Plans (BDPs) and move toward operational stability.

DLPAF involves key stakeholders — StCB, DCCBs, and the State Government — to build a collaborative financial system.

4.1.1 Contributions as per Financial Health of StCB and DCCBs

- Both StCB & DCCB are in overall profit: 50% each by StCB and DCCB.
- StCB in profit, DCCB in loss: Split equally between StCB and State Govt.
- StCB in loss, DCCB with profit (despite accumulated loss): Equal contributions by StCB, DCCB, and State Govt.
- Both StCB & DCCB in loss: Fully supported by State Govt.

4.2 Potentially Viable PACS

A Potentially Viable PACS refers to a PACS that, although not currently profitable, demonstrates the structural capacity, member base, business potential, and operational intent to achieve financial self-sufficiency within a defined time frame — typically 3 to 5 years. Key attributes include:

- **Basic Infrastructure:** Own or functional premises, digital readiness ('ePACS Only' under CSPCP), and physical assets.
- **Governance Structure:** Elected Board and functioning management committee, audit compliance in progress or achievable with support.

- Operational Base: Active membership, access to finance from higher tier, and willingness to diversify into non-credit business activities.
- Location Advantage: Situated in a rural or semi-rural area with demand for agri-inputs, credit, PDS, CSC, or other services.
- Growth Willingness: Demonstrates readiness to participate in institutional strengthening through BDP duly approved by the DLPC.

4.3 Provision for Access to Tapered Funding

Interest-free or soft loans may be extended to PACS/LAMPS/FSS through DLPAF to support HR-related expenses, particularly salaries and operational costs, on a tapering basis.

4.3.1 Financial Support Structure and Conditions

- Submission of a Business Development Plan (BDP) projecting growth in both credit and non-credit portfolios.
- Quarterly and annual review of actual vs projected business, validated by the DLPC.
- PACS must meet minimum activity thresholds aligned with the HR deployed.
- Fund utilization certificates (FUCs) must be submitted quarterly to DLPC and DCCB/StCB.

Table 5: Tapering Model of Financial Support to Potentially Viable PACS

Year	Suitable for	Eligibility	Support %	Remarks
Year 1	Computerized PACS – Seeking financial support	‘ePACS Only’ PACS in loss or financial stress but potentially viable	100%	BDP must include plan for introducing new/additional non-credit services, increase in membership
Year 2	PACS with Growing Business, but Low Profit Margin	Moderate transaction volumes but inadequate surplus to cover HR expenditure	80%	Must progressively reduce reliance on support and increase fee-based services.
Year 3	(continued)	(continued)	60%	
Year 4	Diversified PACS with Credit and Non-Credit Services	Growing business and moving towards sustainability	40%	Faster route to profitability expected; staff cost amortized across services
Year 5	(continued)	(continued)	20%	

Note: This support is conditional and based on annual business development progress and utilization review. The responsibilities of DLPC will be performed by SLPC in 2-tier structure.

4.3.2 Profitability and Sustainability Milestones

- Year 3: The PACS must demonstrate operational profitability, i.e., total revenue should cover all variable costs such as staff salaries, interest cost on funds, utilities, etc.

- Year 5: The PACS is expected to achieve full financial sustainability, wherein it can operate without any external financial support.

4.3.3 Provision for Non-Compliance

PACS failing to meet profitability by Year 3 or business sustainability by Year 5 shall be subject to:

- Withdrawal of remaining support, and/or
- Review of staffing structure by DLPC, including redeployment or downsizing.
- Stoppage of support from StCB/DCCB until course correction or performance improvement is demonstrated.
- Recovery of support amount with or without penalty from capital of PACS under the direction of RCS/State government, in case of misuse, diversion of funds, or gross negligence.

In exceptional cases (e.g., natural calamity, market failure), PACS may seek special dispensation through the SLPC.

4.4 State Level PACS Assistance Fund (SLPAF)

SLPAF combines State and StCB funds to support PACS in 2-tier structure. If the StCB is in profit, SLPAF will be created from equal contribution from StCB and State. If StCB is in loss, it is entirely supported by State/UT government. Neither MoC nor NABARD shall contribute to SLPAF.

5. Staff Strength and Assessment of Vacancies

5.1 Determining Staff Requirements

PACS/LAMPS/FSS will submit staffing proposals to DLPC, which will review, approve and forward them to SLPC for information and initiation of recruitment process. Staffing must match each PACS's business plan, service needs and growth potential.

5.2 Human Resource Information System (HRIS)

Each State shall establish a comprehensive, centralized Human Resource Information System (HRIS) in coordination with NABARD. This system will integrate the HRMS module of ePACS and the software infrastructure developed under the RCS Computerization Project.

Table 6: User Role and Access in HRIS

User Role	Access
PACS Secretary	View and update PACS-level employee records, vacancy assessment and editable auto-generated vacancy status
SLPC/DLPC Secretariat	Access performance dashboards, vacancy assessments, and support funding eligibility; review district-level HR data; verify recruitment, training, and transfer entries; monitor state-wide HR compliance; approve senior-level appointments; policy oversight, system configuration, user management, and access control enforcement.
NABARD, StCB/DCCBs	Audit access, dashboard analytics, HR trend reporting for policy guidance

Note: All users shall be assigned roles with clearly defined permissions and login credentials. Data access shall follow State IT security policies and national data protection guidelines.

5.3 Staffing for Branches of PACS/LAMPS/FSS

For PACS with multiple branches, staffing will be determined by business volume, service range, location, and transaction frequency. The Board, in consultation with the DLPC, will approve branch-specific staffing norms. Periodic reviews and staff redeployment shall be undertaken by the Board to optimise human resource utilization across branches.

5.4 Cost-Efficiency Benchmarks

PACS must follow clear financial and operational norms while deciding staffing needs:

- The total staff expenditure should be capped at 30% of the total revenue.
- Administrative expenses, inclusive of staff costs, must remain below 50% of the total revenue.
- Sub-staff strength should be limited to 10–15% of the total staff; associated staff cost should not exceed 15% of total income.
- All HRIS data shall be kept in NLDR to ensure MIS generation.

5.5 Vacancy Assessment Process

The DLPC shall assess existing and anticipated vacancies over a two-year financial cycle. This review will include: assessment of staff in position as on the first day of the financial year; projected retirements within the next two years; and surplus staff in other PACS/LAMPS/FSS that may be redeployed. The vacancy assessment report must be submitted to the SLPC for approval and initiation of recruitment.

5.5.1 Standard Practices for Vacancy Notification

- Public advertisement of vacancies.
- Disclosure of key information: post titles, salary scales, qualifications, age limits, and reservation norms.
- Publication through local newspapers and institutional notice boards.

5.5.2 Resource Sharing Protocol

- A Secretary may manage multiple PACS/LAMPS/FSS as decided by DLPC, if each PACS/LAMPS/FSS has a business level below ₹25 lakh (based on the latest audited balance sheet) for up to three years from the date of adoption of HR Policy. The period may be extended by 2 more years by DLPC. Overall, Secretary should not manage multiple societies beyond 5 years.
- PACS/LAMPS with turnover above ₹25 lakh must appoint a full-time Secretary.

6. Recruitment and Selection Process

6.1 Recruitment Guidelines

Recruitment shall be biennial (or as required), following a transparent, merit-based procedure:

- Written Examinations: 75% weightage.
- Interviews: 10% weightage.
- Additional marks (up to 15%) for cooperative-specific degree/diploma recognised by State government.

- Interviews and extra marks apply only for Secretary, Manager, and Accountant/AE roles.
- Recruitment may be done through IBPS or State Recruitment Board.

Table 7: Recruitment Guidelines for Different Roles in PACS

Sr.	Position	Criteria	Qualifications	Recruitment Process	Evaluation Method	Additional Notes
1	Secretary, Manager	Age: 21–40	Bachelor's degree; Degree/Diploma in Cooperative Management preferred	Written exam (75%), Interview (10%), Bonus for certifications (15%)	Exams by independent organisation (e.g., IBPS); DLPC oversees interviews; 1:4 shortlist ratio	Computer proficiency mandatory; salary increment for C-PEC/BIRD certifications
2	Accountant, AE	Age: 21–40	Bachelor's degree; Diploma in Cooperative Management preferred	Written exam (80%), Interview (10%), Bonus for certifications (10%)	Same as Secretary/Manager	Computer proficiency mandatory
3	Specialist	Age: 21–40	As prescribed per requirement	Via local employment exchanges, written examination	Independent organisation	Computer proficiency mandatory; preference for local area
4	DEO/Clerk	Age: 21–40	HSC/12th grade; computer proficiency mandatory	Via local employment exchanges, written examination	Independent organisation	Certificate or demonstrated computer knowledge required

6.2 Compliance Norms for Existing Staff at PACS/LAMPS/FSS

All currently serving Secretaries and Assistant Executives who do not meet the prescribed minimum qualifications and have more than 10 years of service remaining shall be required to acquire the stipulated qualifications within maximum five years from the date of implementation of this HR Policy (degrees in 3 years, diploma in 2 years). Secretary/Manager/Accountant/AE shall be trained within 15 days on all ePACS software modules post announcement of 'ePACS Only'.

6.3 Provision for Transition of Charge in Case of Vacancy of Secretary

In case of retirement, resignation, or any unexpected vacancy of the Secretary, a smooth and clear handover must be ensured. The Board of the PACS, in consultation with the DLPC/SLPC/representative of RCS, shall proactively make arrangements for charge handover. This may involve appointment of an interim or acting Secretary, in no case exceeding 3 months, during which period regular recruitment should be effected.

6.4 Reservation Policy

The rules of reservation in recruitment shall be followed as per the applicable norms of the respective State/UT Government.

6.5 Validity of Empanelled List

The list of selected or wait-listed candidates, empanelled through the recruitment process, shall remain valid for a period of two years from the date of declaration of results.

6.6 Formalization of Appointment Process

- **Written Examination and Interview as Core Criteria:** All direct recruitments shall be primarily based on a competitive written examination followed by an interview, except for positions below AE.
- **Approval by DLPC:** The appointment of key functionaries — particularly Secretaries, Managers and AEs — shall require approval from DLPC.
- **Issuance of Appointment Letter:** Upon selection and approval, the Management Committee of the concerned PACS/LAMPS/FSS shall issue the formal appointment letter.

7. Probation and Confirmation

7.1 Probation Periods and Confirmation

Secretary/Manager/Assistant Executive/Accountant will undergo a probation period of one year from their start date. Specialists/DEOs/Clerks will have a probation period of six months from their date of hire. The Board of PACS/LAMPS/FSS is responsible for approving the completion of employees' probationary service.

8. Compensation and Benefits

8.1 Scales of Pay

Guiding Principle: Salary payment for PACS/LAMPS/FSS staff may be funded from within the cooperative ecosystem — through PACS own revenues, DCCB/StCB contributions, and State Government support.

Recognising the wide variation in States' financial capacities, cooperative structures, and legislative frameworks, three alternative Salary Models have been recommended¹. States may adopt one of the three models in full, or may adopt an approved hybrid variant, with the selected model formally notified by the State in accordance with section 16.1.

8.1.1 Model A: Structured Pay Scale (Recommended Default)

This model provides a traditional pay-scale structure with increments and allowances, aligned with DCCB/StCB pay norms. It is suitable for States with well-functioning DCCBs and StCBs that can anchor the salary framework.

¹ **Benchmark reference:** *The three models draw on salary structures in the MGNREGA, AP Village and Ward Secretariat scheme (fixed consolidated emoluments with grade-based differentiation), and performance-linked variable pay with defined service tenures.*

Table 8: Structured Pay Scale — Model A

Sr.	Designation	Pay Scale (₹)	Entry Basic Pay (₹)	Increment	Remarks
1	Secretary	₹15,000–40,000	₹15,000	₹1,000/year	Overall management and business development
2	Manager	₹12,000–30,000	₹12,000	₹750/year	Assists Secretary; suitable for medium to large PACS
3	AE/Accountant	₹10,000–25,000	₹10,000	₹600/year	Financial record maintenance, audit compliance
4	Specialist	₹12,000–25,000	₹12,000	₹750/year	Major focus on non-credit businesses
5	Clerk/DEO	₹8,000–18,000	₹8,000	₹500/year	ERP entry, cash book – Maker
6	Peon	₹6,000–12,000	₹6,000	₹300/year	Assisting staff, internal logistics

Note: Pay scales shall be reviewed every five years, with provision for a Cost-of-Living Adjustment (COLA). Where PACS/LAMPS/FSS staff currently receive higher pay, such pay may be retained provided overall manpower cost stays within Section 5.4 benchmarks.

8.1.2 Model B: Fixed Consolidated Emoluments

This model provides a single, all-inclusive consolidated monthly emolument per designation, without separate components for DA, HRA, or allowances. Inspired by the MGNREGA, NRLM, AP Village and Ward Secretariat model which is suitable for States seeking simplicity in payroll administration.

Table 9: Fixed Consolidated Emoluments — Model B

Sr.	Designation	Consolidated Monthly Emolument (₹)	Annual Revision Basis	Remarks
1	Secretary	₹20,000–25,000	CPI-linked revision every 2 years, notified by SLPC	Consolidated; all-inclusive; no separate DA/HRA. State may fix a higher amount.
2	Manager	₹16,000–20,000	CPI-linked revision every 2 years	Consolidated emolument
3	AE/Accountant	₹14,000–18,000	CPI-linked revision every 2 years	Consolidated emolument
4	Specialist	₹16,000–20,000	CPI-linked revision every 2 years	May vary by specialisation (e.g.,

				Pharmacist, IT Operator)
5	Clerk/DEO	₹12,000–15,000	CPI-linked revision every 2 years	Consolidated emolument
6	Peon	₹8,000–10,000	CPI-linked revision every 2 years	Consolidated emolument

Note: Under Model B, no separate DA, HRA, or increment tables apply. SLPC to notify revised emoluments biannually based on CPI index changes. This model may be adopted by States where PACS revenues are insufficient to sustain traditional pay-scales.

8.1.3 Model C: Performance-Linked Variable Compensation

This model provides a base fixed pay supplemented by a variable performance-linked component tied to PACS business outcomes. It is suitable for States wishing to directly link staff compensation with PACS performance.

Table 10: Performance-Linked Variable Compensation – Model C

Sr.	Designation	Fixed Base Pay (₹/month)	Variable Component	Performance Trigger	Remarks
1	Secretary	₹12,000	Up to 40% of Base Pay	BDP achievement ≥80%; Non-credit income growth ≥15% YoY	Total earnings capped per Model A ceiling
2	Manager	₹10,000	Up to 35% of Base Pay	BDP implementation; branch compliance	Total earnings capped per Model A ceiling
3	AE/Accountant	₹8,000	Up to 30% of Base Pay	Audit closure within 3 months; zero adverse findings	Linked to financial accuracy metrics
4	Specialist	₹10,000	Up to 40% of Base Pay	Non-credit revenue from specialisation area	Directly incentivises diversification
5	Clerk/DEO	₹7,000	Up to 20% of Base Pay	Transaction volume; 100% daily digital compliance	Linked to ePACS system logs
6	Peon	₹6,000	NA	NA	NA

Note: Under Model C, the variable component is paid quarterly based on verified PACS performance metrics assessed by DLPC. In no case shall the total emolument fall below the applicable State minimum wage. The fixed base constitutes the guaranteed component; variable pay is contingent on performance. PACS in deficit shall pay only the base component until profitability is restored.

8.1.4 Common Provisions Across All Models

- The State Government shall select and formally notify the applicable Salary Model (A, B, or C) or an approved hybrid variant through an Order/Circular. All PACS in the State shall implement the notified model uniformly.
- Where PACS/LAMPS/FSS staff are currently receiving higher pay than the model provides, such pay may be retained provided overall manpower cost stays within Section 5.4 benchmarks.
- The minimum salary in any model shall not fall below the applicable State Minimum Wage for the corresponding work category.
- Pay revision cycles shall be as specified in the respective model.
- Terminal and welfare benefits specified in Sections 8.3 and 8.4 apply under all three models unless the State specifies otherwise.

8.2 Allowances

Applicability: Allowances under Section 8.2 apply primarily to States adopting Model A. States adopting Model B (consolidated emoluments) or Model C (performance-linked variable pay) may optionally extend specific allowances as notified by SLPC, subject to Section 5.4 benchmarks.

8.2.1 Dearness Allowance (DA)

The Dearness Allowance will be admissible as per the approach used by the respective DCCBs (or StCB for a 2-tier structure), with a minimum of:

- Secretaries/Manager: ₹2,000/month
- Accountant/Assistant Executives: ₹1,500/month
- Specialists/Clerk/DEO: ₹1,000/month

8.2.2 House Rent Allowance (HRA)

As per the state policy. Employees provided with PACS/LAMPS/FSS accommodation shall not be entitled to HRA.

8.2.3 Travel and Daily Allowance (TA/DA)

TA/DA shall be prescribed by the DLPC based on city classification (Tier-I, II, III) and State policy and revised periodically.

8.3 Performance Incentives

- Employees shall be eligible for an annual performance incentive as detailed in Figure 1. Upper limit is given in Figure 1; actual payment may be decided by the Board.
- PACS which are in profit and have not taken support fund from DLPAF/SLPAF are only eligible for distribution of performance incentives to their staff. Total salary expenses, including incentives, shall be kept within the limits prescribed in Section 5.4.
- Staff acquiring relevant qualifications from C-PEC, BIRD certifications as prescribed by the State competent authority, during service may be eligible for one salary increment (as per the grade-wise annual increment).
- The State/UT may consider a PACS Incentive Program to reward PACS for improving in areas like business growth, member increase, digital compliance, staff training, audits, and innovation.

- Under Model C (Performance-Linked Variable Pay), the variable component defined in Table 8C replaces the separate performance incentive layer. PACS on Model C are not required to additionally operate the performance incentive structure, unless notified by the State.

Table 11: Performance Incentive for PACS

Characteristic	Performance Threshold	Incentive	Measurement	Remarks
Business Volume Growth	≥20% growth over previous year	Max. 1 month's salary	Audited Annual Accounts	Total incentive pool distributed based on staff pay grades
Active Membership Increase	≥12% net addition in active members	₹5,000–₹20,000	Membership Register & Audit Verification	Tiered incentive for PACS with larger outreach
Non-Credit Business Adoption	≥15% YoY growth	₹10,000–₹30,000	Business Transaction Records/BDP	Encourages diversification
MoC Scheme Services Onboarding	At least 2 additional services offered by MoC along with 3 other services	₹5,000	MoUs and verified implementation reports	Validated by DLPC/RCS
Digital Compliance & Reporting	100% daily compliance for 12 months	₹10,000	ePACS System Logs	Mandatory for computerised PACS
Staff Capacity Building	1 certified training completed annually	₹500 per eligible staff	Certificate from C-PEC or recognised institution	Encourages professionalisation
Timely Audit & Compliance	Audit completed within 3 months of year-end	₹5,000	Audit Report & Registrar's Acknowledgement	Promotes financial discipline
Innovation/Best Practices	Pilot approved by DLPC/SLPC	₹5,000–₹25,000	Documentation & Committee Approval	

8.4 Welfare Measures

A. Insurance: Employees shall be covered under Accidental Death and Life Insurance and Health Insurance (for self, spouse, and two dependent children). Premium sharing: 50% by the employee and 50% by PACS/LAMPS/FSS (or as per the State policy).

B. Gratuity: Staff with minimum 5 years of continuous service shall be eligible. Gratuity shall be paid at 15 days' Basic + DA for each completed year of service. Maximum limit: ₹2.50 lakh. SLPC/DLPC may facilitate Group Gratuity Schemes via recognized insurers.

C. Death in Service Benefit: A one-time lump sum of ₹50,000 shall be provided by PACS/LAMPS/FSS to the immediate family of a deceased employee.

D. Festival Advance: Eligible PACS/LAMPS/FSS (not availing DLPAF and debt-free from higher agencies) may grant a festival advance equivalent to one month's salary. Recovery in 10 equal interest-free monthly instalments.

E. Personal Loan Facility: Confirmed staff with minimum 5 years of continuous service may apply. Loan limit: ₹1,00,000, repayable in 120 EMIs. Interest rate shall not be lower than the cost of fund/borrowing rate of PACS/LAMPS/FSS.

F. Maternity Leave: Female employees shall be entitled to maternity leave as per State Government norms and Maternity Benefit Act, 1961.

G. Pension Scheme: A contributory pension scheme may be developed by SLPC, either through an in-house model or by partnering with NPS or as per the State policy.

H. Provident Fund: A mandatory contributory Provident Fund scheme may be considered/designed by SLPC for all regular PACS/LAMPS/FSS employees.

All the compensation and benefits detailed under Section 8 may be customised by the State as per State Act/rules/regulations.

9. Leave and Other Entitlements

9.1 Types of Leave

Casual Leave, Sick/Earned Leave, and Medical Leave benefits may be provided in accordance with the policies of the concerned DCCB, or the StCB in the case of a 2-tier structure, or as decided by the competent authority.

9.2 Leave Encashment Policies

Eligibility for earned leave encashment:

- **Yearly Encashment:** Employees of profitable PACS/LAMPS/FSS would be eligible to encash a maximum of 15 days of earned leave per year. Those working for PACS/LAMPS/FSS that depend on the DLPAF are not eligible for this annual benefit.
- **Terminal Encashment:** All PACS/LAMPS/FSS employees, regardless of their society's financial standing, can encash up to a maximum of 240 days of earned leave upon retirement, superannuation, or death.

10. Career Progression and Transfers

10.1 Promotion Policies

The following progression framework outlines the standard promotional pathways for PACS/LAMPS/FSS employees. Promotions shall be performance-based, with flexibility to accommodate exceptional merit and institutional needs.

Table 10: Promotion Criteria for Various Designations

Table 12: Promotion Criteria for Various Designations

Current Designation	Next Promotional Level(s)	Promotion Criteria
Clerk/DEO	Assistant Executive/Accountant	Exceptional performance, skill enhancement, certification in relevant functions (e.g., accounting, IT)
Specialist	Assistant Executive/Accountant	Leadership and project management skills, functional specialization
Assistant Executive/Accountant	Manager	Demonstrated leadership, strategic acumen, and deep sectoral knowledge
Manager	Secretary	Proven performance in leadership, policy understanding, and organizational management

Table 13: Promotion Eligibility Matrix for PACS/LAMPS/FSS Staff

Sr.	Current Designation	Promotional Post	Min. Years	Min. Qualification	% by Promotion	% by Direct Recruitment
1	Clerk/DEO	AE/Accountant	10 years	As prescribed for AE/Accountant in Section 6.1	–	100%
2	Specialist	AE/Accountant	5 years	As prescribed for AE/Accountant in Section 6.1	–	100%
3	AE/Accountant	Manager	5 years	As prescribed for Manager in Section 6.1	50%	50%
4	Manager	Secretary	5 years	As prescribed for Secretary in Section 6.1	50%	50%
5	Secretary	DCCB/StCB	6 years	As per qualification decided by DCCBs/StCB	50%	50%

- Promotion shall be subject to performance appraisal and availability of position.
- If no eligible internal candidates are available, posts may be filled via direct recruitment through SLPC advertisement.
- In DCCBs/StCB, half of vacancies in Staff Assistant, Clerk, and Supervisor categories will be earmarked for PACS/LAMPS/FSS staff.
- Age relaxation for internal candidates shall be governed by applicable State Government norms.
- Career progression from lower cadres must be prioritised while filling vacancies.

10.2 Transfer Guidelines

10.2.1 Secretary, Manager and Assistant Executive Transfers

- **Transfer Frequency:** In general, transfers should occur every 5 years within the same district. A Secretary/Manager/AE should not serve in the same PACS/LAMPS/FSS for more than 8 years continuously.
- **Salary Protection:** Transferred employees will retain their existing pay scale regardless of the financial capacity of the new PACS/LAMPS/FSS.
- **Transfer Timing:** As decided by DLPC.
- **Transfer Process:** Standard handover procedures to be framed by SLPC. DLPC to execute transfers based on policy guidelines.
- **Financial Buffering:** In case of transfer to a financially weaker PACS/LAMPS/FSS, DLPAF/SLPAF may be used to cover salary disparities.

10.2.2 Specialist/DEOs/Clerks

In general, Specialist/DEOs/Clerks shall not be transferred. In exceptional cases, DLPC may approve intra-district transfers with adequate justification. The salary of PACS/LAMPS/FSS officials at any grade shall not be affected due to transfer.

11. Performance Appraisal and Increments

11.1 Annual Performance Appraisal Process

Annual Performance Appraisals for PACS/LAMPS/FSS Staff are conducted in April each year, covering the twelve parameters listed in Table 11 below.

Table 14: Performance Appraisal Parameters

S.N o.	Parameter	Secretary	Manager	AE/Accountant	Specialist	Clerk/DEO	Reviewer
1	Business Development	BDP achievement, diversification	BDP targets	BDP data & MIS	New services contribution	Transaction support	Chairperson
2	Non-Credit Business Share	Targets & product expansion	Execution & tie-ups	Monitoring & MIS	Support operations	Entry & processing	Chairperson
3	Regulatory Compliance	Returns, audit closures	Branch audit compliance	Financial & statutory data	Operational compliance	Voucher documentation	Chairperson
4	Accounting Records Quality	High-level monitoring	Financial accuracy	Primary accounting responsibility	Compliance support	Record handling	Secretary/Chairperson

S.N o.	Parameter	Secretary	Manager	AE/Accountant	Specialist	Clerk/DEO	Reviewer
5	Standard Operating Procedures	Ensures standardisation	Adheres and enforces	Follows processes	Follows SOPs	Follows SOPs	Secretary/Chairperson
6	Negative Incidents	Reporting and mitigation	Resolution implementation	MIS correction	Issue tracing	Incident recording	Secretary/Chairperson
7	Operational Efficiency	Digital enablement & ERP usage	Resource management	Process digitization	Timely outputs	Data timeliness	Secretary/Chairperson
8	Customer/Member Satisfaction	Feedback systems	Grievance redressal	Transaction accuracy	Field feedback	Frontline service	Secretary/Chairperson
9	Teamwork & Leadership	Staff management	Unit leadership	Team coordination	Team contribution	Responsiveness	Secretary/Chairperson
10	Training & Capacity Building	Attends & conducts	Attends, mentors	Attends and applies	Trains peers	Mandatory training	Secretary/Chairperson
11	Innovation & Initiative	Policy & outreach ideas	Local process improvement	ERP reporting innovation	Process suggestions	Efficient handling	Secretary/Chairperson
12	Overall Contribution	Vision execution, governance	Staff development	Efficiency, accuracy	Scheme contribution	Record support	Secretary/Chairperson

11.2 Appraisal Process by Role

- Secretary: Completes a self-appraisal at the end of each financial year, reviewed and commented on by the PACS/LAMPS/FSS Chairman.
- Manager/Assistant Executive/Accountant: Prepare annual self-appraisal reports for the Secretary to review.
- Specialist: Prepares annual self-appraisal reports for the Secretary to confirm.
- Clerk/DEO: The PACS/LAMPS/FSS Secretary/Manager/AE records the performance appraisal reports for sub-staff.

11.3 Reporting and Documentation

Copies of all self-appraisal and performance appraisal reports must be filed in the Service Records at both the PACS/LAMPS/FSS and DLPC by September of each financial year.

12. Disciplinary Procedures

12.1 Disciplinary Action Guidelines

Table 15: Disciplinary Type and Details

S.No.	Type	Details
1	Misconduct (Illustrative List)	Derelection of duty; Neglect of work; Wilful subordination/disobedience; Engaging in unrelated trade; Irregular attendance; Breach of rules; Disorderly behaviour including intoxication; Dishonesty, theft, bribery, forgery; Instigation of above acts
2	For all PACS/LAMPS/FSS officials	Initiation: By President of PACS for Secretary based on complaint, audit/inspection report, referral from higher authority, or court order. For other officials, Secretary initiates. Due Process: Fair opportunity to defend. Inquiry: Conducted by an officer not below Branch Manager of DCCB. Punishment: Imposed by PACS/LAMPS/FSS President or Board of Management.
3	MIS and Record Keeping	The PACS will submit compliance to DLPC or SLPC (in case of 2-tier) annually.

12.2 Appeals Process

- For Secretaries: The DLPC serves as the Appellate Authority for disciplinary actions taken against Secretaries.
- For Other Staff: The President or the Board of Management of their respective societies are the Appellate Authorities.

12.3 Standardised Notice Period for Resignation by Staff

Table 16: Notice Period of Staff

Designation	Notice Period
Clerk	30 days
DEO	30 days
Specialist	60 days
Accountant/AE	60 days
Manager	60 days
Secretary	60 days

In the case of resignation, the minimum notice period must be served as prescribed above, failing which PACS/LAMPS/FSS officials need to pay an amount of ₹25,000 to the PACS/LAMPS/FSS as a fine.

13. Training and Capacity Building

13.1 Training and Education of PACS/LAMPS/FSS Officials

The SLPC and DLPC shall be responsible for identifying the training and capacity-building needs of PACS personnel. These bodies shall coordinate with appropriate training institutions to ensure that all PACS staff are provided adequate and timely training.

13.1.1 Indicative Training Areas Based on Role Designation

Table 17: Indicative Training Areas Based on Role Designation

No.	Course Title	Target Role(s)	Type	Frequency	Cert.	Mode
1	Introduction to PACS Operations & Cooperative Principles	All Roles	Induction	On Joining	Mandatory	Offline
2	Common Accounting System (CAS)	Secretary, AE, Accountant, Clerk	Core	Every 2 Years	Yes	Online
3	Business Development Planning & Execution (BDP)	Secretary, Manager, Specialist	Core	Annual	Yes	Online/Hybrid
4	ePACS/ERP System Usage	All Roles	Technical	Annual Refresher	Yes	Online
5	Financial Compliance, Audit, and Internal Control	Secretary, Manager, AE/Accountant	Compliance	Biennial	Yes	Online
6	Customer Service & Grievance Redressal Mechanism	Clerk, DEO	Soft Skills	Biennial	Optional	Online
7	Governance and Regulatory Framework for PACS	Secretary, Manager	Governance	Once in 3 years	Yes	Online/Offline
8	Risk Management & Asset Liability Management (ALM)	Secretary, Manager, Accountant	Specialized	Biennial	Yes	Online/Hybrid

No.	Course Title	Target Role(s)	Type	Frequency	Cert.	Mode
9	Agri & Non-Credit Business Models for PACS	Secretary, Manager, Specialist	Business Dev.	Annual	Optional	Online/Offline
10	Leadership and Team Management	Secretary, Manager	Behavioural	Once in 3 years	Optional	Offline
11	Digital Payments, Cybersecurity, and Data Privacy	All Roles	Digital Literacy	Annual Refresher	Yes	Online
12	Monitoring & Evaluation of PACS Operations	Manager, AE, DLPC Staff	Monitoring	Biennial	Optional	Online
13	Disciplinary Procedure, Ethics & Integrity in Cooperatives	All Supervisory Roles	Ethics	Every 3 Years	Optional	Online
14	Gender Sensitization & Inclusive Rural Service Delivery	All Roles	Social	Once in service tenure	Optional	Online
15	Refresher Program on Latest Govt. Schemes and Cooperative Sector Reforms	Secretary, AE, Specialist	Policy	As per notification	Yes	Online

13.1.2 Learning Management System (LMS) Governance Framework

Table 18: Responsibilities in LMS Governance Framework

Level	Responsibility
SLPC/State Body	Policy formulation, content standardization, periodic review.
DLPC	Nomination tracking, compliance enforcement, certification approval, grievance redressal.

PACS Level	User engagement, tracking of training needs, updating service records, facilitating offline sessions.
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13.1.3 Training Logistics and Funding

- Training programmes shall preferably be of short duration and be conducted at the DCCB level.
- The DLPC shall facilitate the nomination of high-performing Secretaries to reputed institutions such as BIRD, VAMNICOM, and CAB, as well as for inter-state exposure visits.
- The State, in coordination with StCB and DCCB, should develop a funding mechanism for capacity building and training for financially weak PACS. PACS which are in profit may bear the cost of training.

13.1.4 Training Monitoring and Compliance Mechanism

- Attendance in training programmes shall be recorded in the individual Service Registers of PACS staff.
- The PACS shall establish a tracking mechanism to monitor, evaluate, and update the training status of all employees, which will be compiled at DLPC.
- Non-participation in nominated training shall have negative implications on the employee's eligibility for future increments and promotions.

13.2 Training for Elected Board Members

- Initial Orientation: All newly elected directors shall undergo initial orientation training covering PACS operations, cooperative laws, identification of business opportunities, and governance frameworks.
- Refresher Courses: Periodic refresher courses shall be organized for board members, preferably held outside the State or District headquarters to allow undisturbed and immersive learning.
- Encouragement for Certification: Elected board members shall be encouraged to pursue the Certification Course on Corporate Governance for Leaders/Board of Directors of Cooperatives, offered by C-PEC, BIRD, Lucknow.
- Board Members should mandatorily register in C-PEC, BIRD and complete the relevant training programme.

14. Outsourcing and Temporary Staffing

14.1 Guidelines for Outsourcing/Temporary Staff

14.1.1 Seasonal and Operational Needs-Based Hiring

The Board of Directors of PACS can assess the need for temporary or outsourced staff during seasonal workload peaks (fertilizer distribution, seeds, pesticides, farm produce procurement). The Secretary may hire temporary staff on a contract or daily wage basis, with prior management approval. Such hiring should not exceed 3 months or go beyond the seasonal requirement, whichever is shorter.

14.1.2 Financial Provisions

The remuneration of outsourced or temporary staff must be exclusively met from the revenue generated by the specific seasonal activity. No expenditure shall be borne out of general PACS funds or the DLPAF/SLPAF.

14.1.3 Alignment with Multi-Service Centre Vision

Each PACS shall institutionalize a mechanism for periodic assessment of seasonal staffing requirements. Engagements must remain strictly time-bound and activity-specific, ensuring efficient resource allocation and service delivery.

15. Miscellaneous Provisions

15.1 Superannuation and Retirement Benefits

The suggested retirement age for PACS staff is 60 years, with the possibility of extending up to 2 additional years, contingent upon DLPC approval. A contributory pension scheme for PACS employees shall be designed and implemented by the SLPC.

15.1.1 Post-Retirement Service Conditions

- Upon attaining the age of 60 years, PACS employees shall ordinarily retire from service.
- Extension of service may be granted for up to two years, subject to DLPC approval and satisfactory performance, physical fitness, and institutional requirements.
- During the extension period, the retired employee shall serve on a contractual basis, not as a regular employee.
- Administrative and financial powers shall be restricted; the individual shall function in an advisory or supervisory capacity only.
- The employee shall be ineligible for further promotion, increments, or regular service benefits.
- Continuation beyond the approved extension period shall not be permitted under any circumstances.

15.2 Compassionate Appointments

The DLPC is empowered to consider applications for compassionate appointment in the event of the demise of a PACS employee. Such appointments shall be subject to relevant policies and eligibility criteria of the concerned State Government, offered preferably within the same district, and contingent on the availability of suitable vacancies.

15.3 Maintenance of Service Registers

- Each PACS employee must have a Service Register maintained in duplicate — one copy retained by the PACS/LAMPS/FSS and the second maintained at the DLPC.
- Annual Verification: SRs must be annually updated and authenticated by Branch Managers of DCCBs (or StCBs in a 2-tier system).
- Inter-Society Transfers: In the event of transfer, the updated SR shall be transferred to the new PACS, with all entries authenticated up to the transfer date.
- Standardisation and Digitisation: A uniform SR format shall be developed by NAFSCOB, with mandatory adoption across all PACS. SRs shall be digitally maintained via the ePACS platform.

- Terminal Benefits Management: All terminal benefits (Gratuity, Provident Fund) must be deposited into a designated account at the DCCB by the concerned PACS/LAMPS/FSS.

16. Amendments and Review

16.1 Enabling Provisions for Adoption of HR Policy

- Amendments to existing government orders, PACS byelaws, and audit guidelines as required.
- Preparation of standard operating formats, process documentation, and implementation toolkits.
- The SLPC shall coordinate and oversee the execution of these amendments.
- The SLPC shall also initiate the process of framing uniform service rules applicable to all cadres of PACS/LAMPS/FSS employees.
- States may customise the Model HR Policy as per State Cooperative Society Act/Rules/GO/instruction from RCS. All customisations — including the choice of Salary Model under Section 8.1 — must be documented and communicated to MoC and NABARD.

16.2 Periodic Review of HR Policy by Committee Constituted by MoC

The PACS HR Policy shall be treated as a dynamic and evolving framework, subject to regular review. The Committee constituted by the Ministry of Cooperation (MoC) shall undertake a comprehensive review every five years. States may conduct interim reviews at periodic intervals based on local requirements and evolving operational dynamics. Reviews shall aim to:

- Ensure compliance with legal and regulatory standards.
- Integrate technological advancements (e.g., ePACS deployment).
- Respond to emerging HR trends, market conditions, and operational realities.
- Promote best practices in human resource management.

17. Special Provisions for Northeastern States

The Northeastern States of India — comprising Assam, Arunachal Pradesh, Manipur, Meghalaya, Mizoram, Nagaland, Sikkim, and Tripura — present a unique cooperative landscape characterised by tribal land ownership patterns, dispersed populations, remote geography, multi-lingual communities, and areas governed under the 5th and 6th Schedules of the Indian Constitution.

17.1 Constitutional and Regulatory Context

- The 6th Schedule of the Indian Constitution (Articles 244(2) and 275(1)) provides for autonomous district councils in the tribal areas of Assam, Meghalaya, Tripura, and Mizoram, with powers to make regulations on management of institutions and cooperative societies.
- The 5th Schedule (Article 244(1)) applies to scheduled areas in other states and empowers Governors to make regulations on cooperative activities in tribal areas.
- PACS operating within 5th and 6th Schedule areas may be subject to regulations enacted by Autonomous District Councils (ADCs) that supplement or modify State cooperative law.
- This HR Policy shall apply to all PACS in NE States subject to applicable ADC regulations; where any provision of this Policy conflicts with a valid ADC regulation, the matter shall be referred to the concerned State Government for resolution.

17.2 Categorization and Staffing Flexibility

In addition to the provisions of Section 2.4, the following specific flexibilities apply to NE States:

- Category F PACS in NE States may be retained with a single Secretary on a shared basis for up to 7 years (instead of the standard 5 years in Section 5.5.2), subject to SLPC approval and annual review.
- For LAMPS operating in geographically isolated areas, the minimum staff norm may be reduced to 1 (Secretary only) for a transitional period of up to 3 years from the date of PACS computerisation, subject to SLPC approval.
- Specialist roles (Table 1) in NE States may include community-specific functions such as market linkage facilitators, bamboo/horticulture input specialists, and tribal land records assistants, which may be added to the approved list by the SLPC without requiring a policy amendment at the national level.

17.3 Recruitment Adaptations

The qualification and selection standards in Section 6.1 are fully applicable in NE States. However, the following procedural adaptations are permitted:

- Written examinations for Secretary, Manager, and AE/Accountant roles may be conducted in the official State language or scheduled tribal language in addition to or instead of the primary medium, as decided by the SLPC.
- Where IBPS or a State Recruitment Board is not available or operationally feasible for a particular district in NE States, the SLPC may constitute a district-level recruitment committee, provided the written examination component (75% weightage) remains competitive and independently administered.
- Age relaxation for candidates belonging to Scheduled Tribes in 5th and 6th Schedule areas shall be as per applicable State/ADC norms, in addition to any general relaxation provided under Section 6.4.
- The empanelled list validity (Section 6.5) may be extended to 3 years (from the standard 2 years) by SLPC in NE States to account for lower recruitment frequency in remote areas.

17.4 Training and Capacity Building

- Training programmes for NE States shall give priority to online and mobile-based delivery modes given connectivity constraints, with offline alternatives mandatorily available at the DCCB/district level.
- NABARD RO may coordinate with BIRD Lucknow and local training institutions (such as NESAC, NERAMAC, and State cooperative training colleges) to develop NE-specific training modules under the LMS framework (Section 13.1.2).
- Training modules shall be made available in the official State language and, where feasible, in scheduled tribal languages of the respective 6th Schedule district.
- SLPC in NE States shall prepare an annual NE-specific Training Calendar in consultation and submit it to NABARD RO by 31st March each year.

17.6 Consultation and Governance

- The final draft of this HR Policy, including NE-specific provisions, shall be placed before PACS Employee Federations operating in NE States and concerned ADCs for consultation before formal adoption.

- State Governments of NE States shall document all adaptations made under this Section in a State-Specific Schedule and submit it to MoC and NABARD within 60 days of adopting the HR Policy.
- The MoC Committee conducting the periodic review (Section 16.2) shall include a representative of at least one NE State when reviewing the applicability and effectiveness of Section 17 provisions.

Note: Nothing in this Section shall be construed to dilute the qualification, selection, or performance standards prescribed in Sections 6.1 and 11 of this Policy. All adaptations under Section 17 are procedural and contextual in nature, and do not affect the substantive HR standards of the Policy.